National Transportation Safety Board
Aviation Accident Final Report

Location:	Sahuarita, AZ	**Accident Number:**	LAX08CA040
Date & Time:	12/20/2007, 1715 MST	**Registration:**	N7229R
Aircraft:	Eldredge Aircamper SDE	**Aircraft Damage:**	Substantial
Defining Event:		**Injuries:**	1 None
Flight Conducted Under:	Part 91: General Aviation - Personal		

Analysis

The pilot observed a car approaching the runway when he was on short final approach for landing at the uncontrolled airport. It appeared to the pilot that the car would cross the runway at midfield just about the time he would be on the landing rollout crossing the same area. The pilot abruptly applied full throttle; however, the engine's power did not increase. The pilot failed to maintain adequate airspeed to touchdown normally, which resulted in a hard landing. Thereafter, the airplane veered off the runway and came to rest with a bent airframe.

Probable Cause and Findings

The National Transportation Safety Board determines the probable cause(s) of this accident to be: The pilot's failure to maintain adequate airspeed. A contributing factor was the pilot's distraction due to the presence of an automobile, which appeared to encroach upon the runway environment.

Findings

Occurrence #1: HARD LANDING
Phase of Operation: LANDING - FLARE/TOUCHDOWN

Findings
1. OBJECT - VEHICLE
2. (F) DIVERTED ATTENTION - PILOT IN COMMAND
3. (C) AIRSPEED - INADEQUATE - PILOT IN COMMAND

Factual Information

Pilot Information

Certificate:	Private	**Age:**	28, Male
Airplane Rating(s):	Single-engine Land	**Seat Occupied:**	
Other Aircraft Rating(s):	None	**Restraint Used:**	Seatbelt, Shoulder harness
Instrument Rating(s):	None	**Second Pilot Present:**	
Instructor Rating(s):		**Toxicology Performed:**	
Medical Certification:	Class 2	**Last FAA Medical Exam:**	03/01/2007
Occupational Pilot:		**Last Flight Review or Equivalent:**	
Flight Time:	161 hours (Total, all aircraft), 53 hours (Total, this make and model), 15 hours (Last 90 days, all aircraft), 2 hours (Last 30 days, all aircraft)		

Aircraft and Owner/Operator Information

Aircraft Make:	Eldredge	**Registration:**	N7229R
Model/Series:	Aircamper SDE	**Aircraft Category:**	Airplane
Year of Manufacture:		**Amateur Built:**	Yes
Airworthiness Certificate:	Experimental	**Serial Number:**	001
Landing Gear Type:	Tailwheel	**Seats:**	
Date/Type of Last Inspection:		**Certified Max Gross Wt.:**	
Time Since Last Inspection:		**Engines:**	1 Reciprocating
Airframe Total Time:		**Engine Manufacturer:**	Continental
ELT:		**Engine Model/Series:**	A-65
Registered Owner:	Stephen D. Eldredge	**Rated Power:**	
Operator:	Andrew Eldredge	**Operating Certificate(s) Held:**	None

Meteorological Information and Flight Plan

Conditions at Accident Site:	Visual Conditions	**Condition of Light:**	Day
Observation Facility, Elevation:		**Distance from Accident Site:**	
Observation Time:		**Direction from Accident Site:**	
Lowest Cloud Condition:	Clear	**Visibility**	10 Miles
Lowest Ceiling:	None	**Visibility (RVR):**	
Wind Speed/Gusts:	Light and Variable /	**Turbulence Type Forecast/Actual:**	/
Wind Direction:		**Turbulence Severity Forecast/Actual:**	/
Altimeter Setting:		**Temperature/Dew Point:**	
Precipitation and Obscuration:	No Obscuration; No Precipitation		
Departure Point:	Sahuarita, AZ (6AZ8)	**Type of Flight Plan Filed:**	None
Destination:	, AZ (6AZ8)	**Type of Clearance:**	None
Departure Time:	MST	**Type of Airspace:**	

Airport Information

Airport:	Flying Diamond (6AZ8)	**Runway Surface Type:**	Asphalt
Airport Elevation:	3800 ft	**Runway Surface Condition:**	Dry
Runway Used:	25	**IFR Approach:**	None
Runway Length/Width:	2650 ft / 35 ft	**VFR Approach/Landing:**	Go Around

Wreckage and Impact Information

Crew Injuries:	1 None	**Aircraft Damage:**	Substantial
Passenger Injuries:	N/A	**Aircraft Fire:**	None
Ground Injuries:	N/A	**Aircraft Explosion:**	
Total Injuries:	1 None	**Latitude, Longitude:**	31.938611, -111.113611

Administrative Information

Investigator In Charge (IIC):	Wayne R Pollack	**Report Date:**	02/28/2008
Additional Participating Persons:	Chris Clark; Federal Aviation Administration; Scottsdale, AZ		
Publish Date:	05/18/2010		
Note:	This accident report documents the factual circumstances of this accident as described to the NTSB.		
Investigation Docket:	NTSB accident and incident dockets serve as permanent archival information for the NTSB's investigations. Dockets released prior to June 1, 2009 are publicly available from the NTSB's Record Management Division at pubinq@ntsb.gov, or at 800-877-6799. Dockets released after this date are available at http://dms.ntsb.gov/pubdms/.		

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The Independent Safety Board Act, as codified at 49 U.S.C. Section 1154(b), precludes the admission into evidence or use of any part of an NTSB report related to an incident or accident in a civil action for damages resulting from a matter mentioned in the report. A factual report that may be admissible under 49 U.S.C. § 1154(b) is available here.